

...

LETTERS TO MY SON

On Silence

16 letters

Father

A father's letters, worth keeping.

A word before you begin

My son,

The world will never be quiet, so you must carry your own stillness. These letters are on solitude, discretion, and the strength of saying less.

Read one a day. Sit with it. Let it change one small thing in how you live.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

You learn men in the room, not in the quiet of your study.

Books give you knowledge; people give you wisdom. Close the book sometimes and watch.

Read the world as carefully as you read the page.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Withdraw into yourself as much as you can.

Crowds undo a man slowly. Keep company with the few who make you better, and with your own thoughts.

Guard your solitude; it is where you are repaired.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The crowd is the worst company a growing man can keep.

You become an average of the noise you let in. Let in less.

Step out of the herd to remember your own pace.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Knowledge of people is gained among them, not in the silence of a study.

Read to fill the mind, but go out to sharpen it. Wisdom needs other faces.

Balance the quiet hours with the crowded ones.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Withdraw into yourself whenever you can.

The man who is never alone never meets himself, and stays
a stranger to his own life.

Keep a room in your day no one else may enter.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The crowd is the most dangerous company for a forming mind.

You leave a throng carrying opinions that were never yours.

Step out of the herd to recover your own pace.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Books fill the mind; people sharpen it; silence settles it.

A man needs all three, and most neglect the last.

Make room for the quiet that lets the rest take root.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Noise is the easiest way to avoid yourself.

You fill every gap with sound, then wonder why nothing is clear.

Let the silence speak; it has been waiting.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Say less than you know.

The man who empties himself in every room is trusted in none.

Let them find your depth; it is worth more discovered.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Solitude only frightens the man at war within.

Make peace inside and an empty room becomes good company.

Build a self you are glad to sit with.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Retire into yourself before the world empties you out.

A man who is always available to everyone belongs to no one, least of all himself.

Keep one room the world cannot enter.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The wise man hears much and says little.

An open mouth and a closed mind is the loudest, emptiest combination.

Listen twice as long as you speak.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Lower your voice and people lean in; raise it and they close up.

Force repels; quiet draws. The calm man owns the room he never shouts in.

Speak softly and watch them come closer.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Silence terrifies those who have not learned to hear.

In silence, you meet yourself.

Your future self will thank you.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Noise in your ears keeps silence from your mind.

Your mind cannot think and hear at once.

Protect this like your life depends on it.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The world will not be quiet, so you must become it.

Your best thoughts arrive in silence, never in din.

Build this into your day.

Yours faithfully,

Father

Keep going

If these served you, there is more.

- A new letter every day — @letters_to_son_eng
- The weekly letter — comment LETTERS to join.
- The full collection and printed keepsakes — coming soon.

Carry these well. One day you may write your own.

Yours faithfully,

Father